

RH06

Rajasthan & the Mughals; Medieval Administration and Revenue System

About 2-3 questions a paper. The politics half gives one, the administrative-revenue vocabulary gives one or two, almost always as match-the-following or a 'NOT correctly matched' pair.

Two halves that look unrelated but are not. The first half is politics - how the Rajput states came into the Mughal order and how some of them went out of it again. The second half is the machinery those states actually ran on: parganas, khalsa land, batai shares, patwaris. The second half is where RPSC scores you, because it is pure vocabulary and it repeats.

Rajasthan under the Mughals

Conquest and alliance

- Khanwa 1527
- Bharmal 1562
- Chittor 1568
- Ranthambore 1569
- Nagaur darbar 1570

Treaties and wars

- Mewar treaty 1615
- Jaziya 1679
- Rajput war 1679-81
- Prince Akbar's revolt
- Ajit Singh restored 1708

Mughal institutions

- Subah of Ajmer 1580
- Seven sarkars
- Mansab: zat and sawar
- Dagh and chehra
- Watan jagir

Units and officials

- Pargana, tapa, hawala
- Pradhan, Diwan, Bakshi
- Hakim, Amil, Faujdar
- Patwari, Chaudhary

Land categories

- Khalsa
- Jagir
- Bhom
- Sasan / Dharmarth
- Doli, Inam

Revenue and cesses

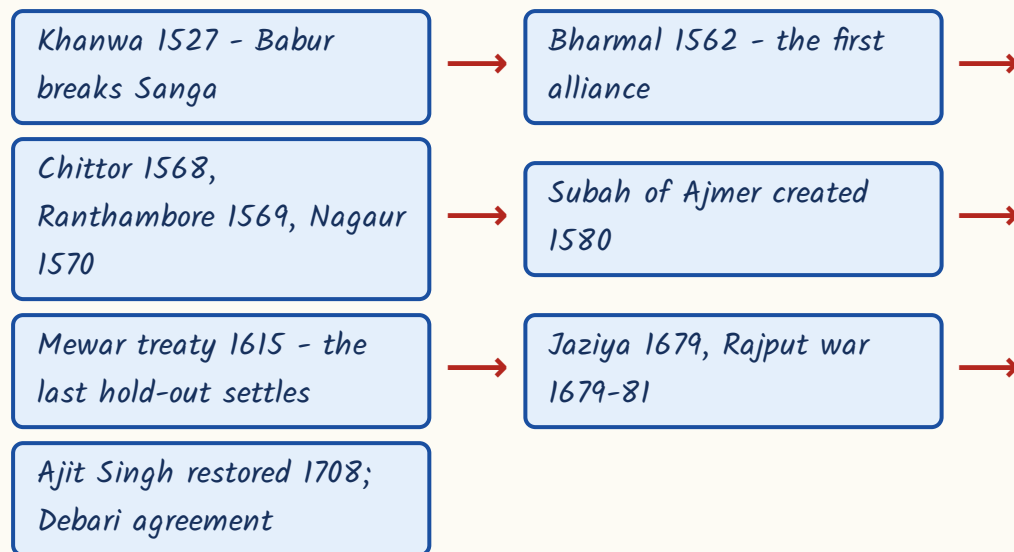
- Batai - Latta and Kunta
- Bighori, Muqata, Hal
- Zabti, Kankut
- Bhaichara
- Lag-Bag, Bethbegar

Two hundred years in one line

Start with the shape of the story, not the dates. Babur breaks Rajput power at Khanwa in 1527. Akbar then does something cleverer than conquest - he offers

the Rajput chiefs service, rank and their own homelands back, and most of them take it. Jahangir closes the last hold-out, Mewar, in 1615. Then Aurangzeb reverses the policy, and the alliance breaks apart in a war that runs from 1679 to 1681 and drags on in Marwar until 1708. Learn that arc and every date in this chapter has a place to sit.

The Rajput-Mughal relationship, start to finish



- Khanwa, 17 March 1527 - Babur defeats Rana Sanga's confederacy.
- Sanga's allies included Medini Rai of Chanderi, a Marwar contingent under Rao Ganga, and the Afghan claimant Mahmud Lodi.
- Mahmud Lodi is the name RPSC picks out - an Afghan pretender fighting on the Rajput side.

YAAD RAKHO

Four dates carry this chapter: 1527 Khanwa, 1568 Chittor, 1615 Mewar treaty, 1679 jaziya. Anchor everything else to those four.

Akbar's Rajput policy - how it actually worked

Akbar's policy was not simply marriage. It was a package: accept Mughal overlordship, take a mansab, serve in the imperial army - and in return keep your ancestral territory as a watan jagir, keep your religion, and rise as high as your ability allows. That is why a Rajput could command Mughal armies against another Rajput at Haldighati. The states that took the deal prospered; the ones that refused were besieged.

- The policy opens in 1562 with Raja BHARMAL of Amber - the first Rajput chief to accept Mughal service and give a daughter in marriage.
- The marriage of Harkha Bai to Akbar took place at SAMBHAR.
- Bharmal's family rose fastest of all - his grandson Man Singh I reached a mansab of 7,000.
- Watan jagirs left Rajput chiefs in possession of their own homelands - the heart of the bargain.
- CHITTOR besieged 23 October 1567 - 23 February 1568; Jaimal of Merta and Patta of Kelwa fell; Akbar later set up their statues at the gate of Agra Fort.
- RANTHAMBORE surrendered in 1569 by Rao Surjan Singh Hada of Bundi, who was given the title 'Rao Raja'; Kalinjar fell the same year.
- The NAGAUR darbar of 1570 drew in Bikaner and Jaisalmer; Rao Chandrasen of Marwar walked out rather than submit.
- MEWAR alone among the major states never gave a daughter in marriage to the Mughals.

Akbar in Rajasthan - the milestone table

Year	Event	Who it involved
1562	First Rajput alliance and marriage at Sambhar	Raja Bharmal of Amber
1567-68	Siege and fall of Chittor	Jaimal of Merta, Patta of Kelwa

Year	Event	Who it involved
1569	Surrender of Ranthambore	Rao Surjan Singh Hada of Bundi
1570	Nagaur darbar	Bikaner and Jaisalmer submit; Chandrasen withdraws
1576	Haldighati	Man Singh I commands for the Mughals
1580	Subah of Ajmer created	Seven sarkars, covering most of Rajasthan
1583	Marwar accepts Mughal suzerainty	Mota Raja Udai Singh

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 - where did Akbar's marriage with Harkha Bai, daughter of Raja Bharmal, take place? Answer: Sambhar. Note the pattern: RPSC prefers the place over the person, because the person is common knowledge.

TRAP

Chandrasen of Marwar was NOT the first Rathore to accept Mughal suzerainty - he is the one who refused. The first was Mota Raja Udai Singh, in 1583. This inversion is planted in statement-based questions.

Jahangir to Aurangzeb - settlement, then rupture

Jahangir finished what Akbar could not: he brought Mewar in, and on terms mild enough for Mewar to keep its honour. Aurangzeb then undid the whole arrangement. He reimposed the jaziya, and when Jaswant Singh I of Marwar died leaving a posthumous heir, he tried to take Marwar into direct control. That is the trigger for the Rajput war.

- MEWAR TREATY OF 1615 - Jahangir with Maharana Amar Singh I, negotiated by Prince Khurram.

- Chittor restored, but never to be repaired; no matrimonial alliance; Prince Karan Singh to attend court in the Rana's place; 1,500 horse to be supplied.
 - Amar Singh I was the first Mewar ruler to accept Mughal suzerainty.
 - The Rathore entry into the Mughal system runs through Mota Raja Udai Singh (1583) and his daughter Jagat Gosain, mother of Shah Jahan.
 - The last Rajput-Mughal marriage was Ajit Singh's daughter to Farrukhsiyar in 1715.
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- AURANGZEB reimposed the JAZIYA in 1679.
 - Jaswant Singh I's death in 1678 opened the Marwar succession dispute - the trigger for the RAJPUT WAR of 1679-81, involving Marwar and Mewar.
 - In 1681 Aurangzeb's own son, Prince Akbar, rebelled with Rajput support and fled to the Marathas; Durgadas Rathore escorted his children.
 - The war ended with a treaty with Mewar's Jai Singh in 1681; Marwar fought on until Ajit Singh's restoration in 1708 and the Debari agreement.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 - the Mewar-Mughal treaty of 1615 was concluded during whose reign? Answer: Jahangir. Expect the follow-up in negative form: 'which was NOT a provision of the 1615 treaty' - the false option is always a marriage clause.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - the Mughal army at Haldighati (1576) was commanded by Man Singh I of Amber. This sits squarely in the Rajput-policy story: a Rajput mansabdar leading Mughal troops against a Rajput ruler is the policy working exactly as designed.

The Mughal frame in Rajasthan - subah, mansab, dagh

Now switch from politics to structure. Akbar did not leave Rajasthan outside his empire; he made it a subah. And the Rajput chiefs inside it were not vassal kings on paper - they were mansabdars inside the MANSABDARI system, ranked officers of the empire whose ranks were neither hereditary nor transferable.

- Akbar created the SUBAH OF AJMER in 1580, one of the twelve original subahs.
- It had SEVEN sarkars: Ajmer, Jodhpur, Chittor, Ranthambore, Nagaur, Sirohi, Bikaner.
- It covered roughly modern Rajasthan - but parts of eastern Rajasthan lay in the Agra and Delhi subahs.
- Man Singh I of Amber held the highest Rajput mansab under Akbar - 7,000.

Zat vs Sawar - do not blur these

Zat	Sawar
Fixes the holder's personal rank and status	Fixes the cavalry contingent he must maintain
Determines his salary	Determines his troop obligation
Higher zat = higher place in the imperial order	Higher sawar = larger horse contingent

- DAGH = branding of horses. CHEHRA (huliya) = the descriptive roll of a soldier.
- Both were enforced by Akbar to stop fraud at musters - borrowed horses, hired men, padded lists.
- Du-aspa / sih-aspa let a noble keep extra troopers without raising his zat rank.

- *Mansabs were neither hereditary nor transferable - a favourite statement to test.*

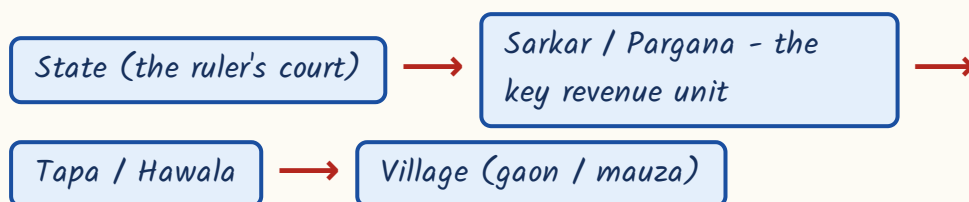
YAAD RAKHO

Dagh is for horses, chehra is for men. Horse gets a brand, man gets a description. If you can hold that one line you have a guaranteed mark.

How a Rajput state was actually run

Below the ruler the state was a pyramid, and the important layer in the middle is the PARGANA - a group of villages, and the real revenue unit. Everything administrative in this chapter attaches to one of four levels: the court, the pargana, the village, or the fort. Learn the officials by the level they sit at, not as one alphabetical list.

Administrative hierarchy of a Rajput state



Central officials - the court level

Official	Department
Pradhan	Prime minister, head of the administration
Diwan	Revenue and finance
Bakshi	Military department - pay and muster
Khan-i-Saman	Stores and household
Kotwal	Law and order, prices and weights in towns
Khajanchi	Treasury
Dyodhidar	Palace security

Official	Department
Waqia-navis	News writer

Pargana and village officials

Level	Official	Function
Pargana	Hakim	Head of the pargana - administrative and judicial
Pargana	Amil / Amalguzar	Revenue collection
Pargana	Faujdar	Police and military duties
Pargana	Potdar	Accounts
Pargana	Khufia-navis	Secret reports
Pargana	Kanungo and Chaudhary	Records and local liaison
Village	Patwari	Land records and revenue
Village	Chaudhary / Muqaddam	Headman
Village	Talwati	Weighing and measuring the produce
Village	Kanwari	Crop protection

TRAP

Dyodhidar is a PALACE official, not a pargana one. 'Which of these was NOT connected with pargana administration' is a real question and Dyodhidar is its answer. Keep the court list and the pargana list physically separate in your memory.

Land and revenue - the vocabulary RPSC actually asks

First understand the logic, then the words. All land in a state fell into one of two broad situations: either the ruler collected from it directly, or he had assigned that right to somebody else - a noble for service, a Bhomia for local

defence, a temple or a Brahmin for charity. Once you see that, the six land categories are just six answers to the question 'who collects here, and why'.

Land categories in medieval Rajasthan

Category	Meaning
Khalsa	Under the direct control of the state
Jagir	Assigned to a noble in return for military or administrative service
Bhom	Hereditary and tax-free, held by Bhomias for local defence and police duty
Sasan / Dharmarth	Tax-free religious grant
Doli	Small tax-free charitable grant
Inam	Reward grant

Now assessment - how much the state took. The default across Rajasthan was BATAI, crop-sharing, with the state's share usually one-third. Batai has two working forms and this is the single most examinable distinction in the chapter: in Latta the crop is cut first and then divided; in Kunta the standing crop is appraised before it is cut. Cut-then-divide versus look-and-estimate.

Latta vs Kunta - the two forms of Batai

Latta (Lata)	Kunta
The crop is harvested first	The crop is still standing
The cut crop is physically divided	The yield is appraised or estimated
Division happens after the harvest	Assessment happens before the harvest

The other assessment systems - term to basis

Term	Basis of assessment
Bighori / Beghodi	Cash rate per bigha, graded by soil fertility
Mugata / Mukata	Fixed lump-sum payment

Term	Basis of assessment
Dori	Assessment by measurement with a rope
Ghughri	Share based on the seed sown
Hal / Halibakshi	Per plough - roughly 15-30 bighas to a plough
Kankut	Estimate of the grain yield
Zabti	Akbar's measurement-based cash system, under Todar Mal
Bhaichara	Joint village-brotherhood assessment; the community shares the burden

TRAP

Two standing errors. First: Zabti is measurement-based cash assessment, NOT a share of the standing crop - that is Kunta. Second: IQTA is a Delhi Sultanate term and was never a land category in medieval Rajasthan; when it appears in the options it is the odd one out.

Cesses, forced labour, ranks and records

Land revenue was never the whole of what a peasant paid. On top of it sat a crowd of customary levies, and on top of those sat unpaid labour. Both have names, and both get asked - usually in the 'NOT correctly matched' format, where a cess is given the wrong definition.

- LAG-BAG = the cesses and customary levies beyond land revenue - Nyauta lag, Chanwari lag on daughters' weddings, Ghar-ginti house tax.
- BETHBEGAR = unpaid forced labour exacted from peasants and artisans. It is labour, not a cash cess - the commonest planted error.
- Udrang = fixed share taken from hereditary holders; Bhag = the state's share of produce; Hiranya = the state's share taken in cash.
- Dastoor = illegal exaction by revenue staff; Barani = unirrigated land.

Feudal ranks - state by state

State	Ranks of the nobility
Mewar	Solah (16) Umrao, Battis (32) Sardar, and Gol
Marwar	Rajvi, Sardar, Ganayat, Mutsaddi
Jaipur	The Barah (12) Kotri, headed by the Rajawat

- Infantry were the Pyade.
- Cavalry were graded Yak-aspa, Du-aspa, Sih-aspa and Nim-aspa - one, two, three horses, or a half share.
- Bargir = state-equipped trooper; Siledar = trooper who brought his own horse and arms.
- Ahadi = the ruler's own standing troops; Jamiyat = a noble's contingent.
- The Rajput states kept bahi-khata record series - Hakikat Bahi, Kamthana Bahi, and Pattas and Parwanas.
- Muhnot Nainsi's 'Marwar ra Pargana ri Vigat' is the classic revenue gazetteer of a Rajput state - pargana by pargana.
- That work is why Nainsi is asked in two different chapters: as a chronicler and as a revenue source.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of January 2025 and still standing in 2026): Rajasthan's own administrative map has been redrawn twice in three years. Nine of the districts and three of the divisions created in 2023 were annulled by the cabinet decision of 28 December 2024, leaving the state with 41 districts and 7 divisions. Worth noticing alongside this chapter - the pargana and sarkar are gone, but the habit of re-cutting revenue units to suit administration is not, and the state's land records still run through the patwari.

REVISION RECAP

1. Khanwa 17 March 1527 - Babur over Sanga; Mahmud Lodi, the Afghan claimant, fought on the Rajput side.
2. Akbar's policy opens in 1562 with Bharmal of Amber; the marriage of Harkha Bai took place at Sambhar.
3. Chittor fell 23 Feb 1568 (Jaimal and Patta, statues at Agra Fort); Ranthambore surrendered 1569 by Rao Surjan Singh Hada.
4. Nagaur darbar 1570 - Bikaner and Jaisalmer submit, Chandrasen walks out.
5. Mewar alone never gave a daughter to the Mughals; Marwar submitted in 1583 under Mota Raja Udai Singh.
6. Mewar treaty 1615 with Jahangir: Chittor back but unrepaired, no marriage tie, Karan Singh to court, 1,500 horse.
7. Aurangzeb reimposed jaziya in 1679; Jaswant Singh I's death (1678) triggered the Rajput war of 1679-81.
8. Prince Akbar's revolt 1681; Mewar treaty 1681; Marwar settled only with Ajit Singh's restoration in 1708.
9. Subah of Ajmer created 1580 with seven sarkars - Ajmer, Jodhpur, Chittor, Ranthambore, Nagaur, Sirohi, Bikaner.
10. Zat = personal rank and pay; Sawar = cavalry to be maintained; mansabs neither hereditary nor transferable.
11. Dagh brands the horse, chehra describes the man; du-aspa and sih-aspa add troopers without raising zat.
12. Hierarchy: state - sarkar/pargana - tappa/hawala - village; the pargana is the key revenue unit.
13. Court: Pradhan, Diwan, Bakshi, Khan-i-Saman, Kotwal, Khajanchi, Dyodhidar, Waqia-navis.
14. Pargana: Hakim heads it, Amil collects, Faujdar polices, Potdar keeps accounts, Khufia-navis reports secretly.
15. Village: Patwari keeps records, Chaudhary/Muqaddam heads the village, Talwati weighs, Kanwari guards the crop.
16. Land: Khalsa direct, Jagir for service, Bhom hereditary and tax-free for defence, Sasan religious, Doli charitable, Inam reward.
17. Batai takes about one-third; Latta divides the cut crop, Kunta appraises the standing crop.
18. Bighori per bigha, Muqata lump-sum, Dori by rope, Ghughri by seed, Hal per plough, Kankut by estimate, Zabt by measurement in cash.
19. Lag-Bag are the extra cesses; Bethbegar is unpaid forced labour; Bhaichara spreads the burden across the village.

20. Feudal ranks: Mewar's Solah Umrao and Battis Sardar, Marwar's Rajvi and Ganayat, Jaipur's Barah Kotri.